Humana. **Claims Payment Policy**

# Subject: Laboratory – Serum Testing for Hepatic Fibrosis in the Evaluation and Monitoring of Chronic Liver Disease

**Application:** Medicare Advantage Products **Published date:** 10/2026

**Policy number:** LAB2026002

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## Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

*As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) as outlined below.*

*In addition to the policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.*

- For chronic hepatitis B, chronic hepatitis C, metabolic dysfunction-associated steatotic liver disease (MASLD) including metabolic dysfunction-associated steatohepatitis (MASH) alcoholic hepatitis, or an elevated liver stiffness measurement, the use of the following multianalyte assays with algorithmic analysis to distinguish hepatic cirrhosis from non-cirrhosis **IS REIMBURSABLE** no more than one test every six months:
  - ELF™ (CPT code 81517***)
  - FibroTest® (CPT code 81596*)
  - HCV FibroSURE® (CPT code 81596*)

- For all other situations not described above, ELF™ (CPT code 81517***), FibroTest® (CPT code 81596*) and HCV FibroSURE® (CPT code 81596*) **ARE NOT REIMBURSABLE**.

- The use of other multianalyte assays with algorithmic analysis (CPT code 0002M**, CPT code 0003M**, CPT code 0166U, CPT code 0344U**, CPT code 0468U**) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE.**

### Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

| Procedure code | Code description |
|---|---|
| 81517*** | Liver disease, analysis of 3 biomarkers (hyaluronic acid [HA], procollagen III amino terminal peptide [PIIINP], tissue inhibitor of metalloproteinase 1 [TIMP-1]), using immunoassays, utilizing serum, prognostic algorithm reported as a risk score and risk of liver fibrosis and liver-related clinical events within 5 years |
| 81596* | Infectious disease, chronic hepatitis c virus (HCV) infection, six biochemical assays (ALT, A2-macroglobulin, apolipoprotein A-1, total bilirubin, GGT, and haptoglobin) utilizing serum, prognostic algorithm reported as scores for fibrosis and necroinflammatory activity in liver |
| 0002M** | Liver disease, ten biochemical assays (ALT, A2-macroglobulin, apolipoprotein A-1, total bilirubin, GGT, haptoglobin, AST, glucose, total cholesterol and triglycerides) utilizing serum, prognostic algorithm reported as quantitative scores for fibrosis, steatosis and alcoholic steatohepatitis (ASH) |

| Procedure code | Code description |
|---|---|
| | Proprietary test: ASH FibroSURE™<br>Laboratory/Manufacturer: BioPredictive S.A.S |
| 0003M** | Liver disease, ten biochemical assays (ALT, A2-macroglobulin, apolipoprotein A-1, total bilirubin, GGT, haptoglobin, AST, glucose, total cholesterol and triglycerides) utilizing serum, prognostic algorithm reported as quantitative scores for fibrosis, steatosis and nonalcoholic steatohepatitis (NASH)<br>Proprietary test: NASH FibroSURE™<br>Laboratory/Manufacturer: BioPredictive S.A.S |
| 0166U | Liver disease, 10 biochemical assays (α2-macroglobulin, haptoglobin, apolipoprotein A1, bilirubin, GGT, ALT, AST, triglycerides, cholesterol, fasting glucose) and biometric and demographic data, utilizing serum, algorithm reported as scores for fibrosis, necroinflammatory activity, and steatosis with a summary interpretation<br>Proprietary test: LiverFASt™<br>Lab/Manufacturer: Fibronostics |
| 0344U** | Hepatology (nonalcoholic fatty liver disease [NAFLD]), semiquantitative evaluation of 28 lipid markers by liquid chromatography with tandem mass spectrometry (LC-MS/MS), serum, reported as at-risk for nonalcoholic steatohepatitis (NASH) or not NASH<br>Proprietary test: OWLiver®<br>Lab/Manufacturer: CIMA Sciences, LLC |
| 0468U** | Hepatology (nonalcoholic steatohepatitis [NASH]), miR-34a-5p, alpha 2-macroglobulin, YKL40, HbA1c, serum and whole blood, algorithm reported as a single score for NASH activity and fibrosis<br>Proprietary test: NASHnext™ (NIS4™)<br>Lab/Manufacturer: Labcorp |

**The payment criteria for 81596 applies to all Medicare jurisdictions, except those states awarded to Novitas Solutions, Inc.*
***The payment criteria for 0002M, 0003M, 0344U, 0468U applies to all Medicare jurisdictions, except those states awarded to CGS Administrators, LLC; Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC; Palmetto GBA; WPS Insurance Corporation.*
****The payment criteria for 81517 applies to all Medicare jurisdictions, except those states awarded to CGS Administrators, LLC; Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC; Palmetto GBA; WPS Insurance Corporation.*

## Original Medicare Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs)

| Contractor name | Policy title | Policy number | Procedure code |
|---|---|---|---|
| CGS Administrators, LLC | MolDX: Molecular Diagnostic Test (MDT) | L36021 | 0002M<br>0003M<br>0344U<br>0468U<br>81517 |
| Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC | MolDX: Molecular Diagnostic Test (MDT) | L35160 | 0002M<br>0003M<br>0344U<br>0468U<br>81517 |
| Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC | MolDX: Molecular Diagnostic Test (MDT) | L36256 | 0002M<br>0003M<br>0344U |
| Novitas Solutions, Inc | Biomarkers Overview | L35062 | 81596 |
| Palmetto GBA | MolDX: Molecular Diagnostic Test (MDT) | L35025 | 0002M<br>0003M<br>0344U<br>0468U<br>81517 |

| Contractor name | Policy title | Policy number | Procedure code |
|---|---|---|---|
| Wisconsin Physician Service Insurance Corporation | MolDX: Molecular Diagnostic Test (MDT) | L36807 | 0002M<br>0003M<br>0344U<br>0468U<br>81517 |

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